Tomorrow, on the small screen: sci-fi series and the futures they imagined

94 TV and streaming series, 1962 to 2026. Each bar runs from the year a series (or the season shown) first aired to the year it is set in, on humanity's current calendar.

Near future (to 2125)

Far future (compressed scale)

1960 1980 2000 2020 2040 2060 2080 2100 2120 // 2500 3000 3500 4000

Today (2026)

1960s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
Fireball XL5	1962	2062	+100 yrs
The Jetsons*	1962	2062	+100 yrs
JP Astro Boy	1963	2013	+50 yrs
Lost in Space	1965	1997	+32 yrs
Thunderbirds*	1965	2065	+100 yrs
Star Trek (The Original Series)	1966	2266	+300 yrs
DE Raumpatrouille Orion	1966	3000	+1,034 yrs
Captain Scarlet and the Mysterons	1967	2068	+101 yrs
Land of the Giants	1968	1983	+15 yrs
Joe 90*	1968	2012	+44 yrs

1970s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
UFO	1970	1980	+10 yrs
Moonbase 3	1973	2003	+30 yrs
Star Trek: The Animated Series*	1973	2269	+296 yrs
JP Space Battleship Yamato	1974	2199	+225 yrs
Planet of the Apes (TV series)	1974	3085	+1,111 yrs
Space: 1999	1975	1999	+24 yrs
Ark II	1976	2476	+500 yrs
1990	1977	1990	+13 yrs
JP Galaxy Express 999	1978	2221	+243 yrs
JP Space Pirate Captain Harlock	1978	2977	+999 yrs
Buck Rogers in the 25th Century	1979	2491	+512 yrs

1980s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
Thundarr the Barbarian*	1980	3994	+2,014 yrs
JP Super Dimension Fortress Macross	1982	2009	+27 yrs
Terrahawks	1983	2020	+37 yrs
The Tripods	1984	2089	+105 yrs
SU Guest from the Future*	1985	2084	+99 yrs
Defenders of the Earth	1986	2015	+29 yrs
The Adventures of the Galaxy Rangers*	1986	2086	+100 yrs
Spiral Zone	1987	2007	+20 yrs
Star Cops	1987	2027	+40 yrs
CA Captain Power and the Soldiers of the Future	1987	2147	+160 yrs
Star Trek: The Next Generation	1987	2364	+377 yrs

1990s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
seaQuest DSV	1993	2018	+25 yrs
Exosquad	1993	2119	+126 yrs
Time Trax*	1993	2193	+200 yrs
Star Trek: Deep Space Nine	1993	2369	+376 yrs
FR Phantom 2040	1994	2040	+46 yrs
CA TekWar	1994	2044	+50 yrs
Earth 2	1994	2192	+198 yrs
Babylon 5	1994	2258	+264 yrs
JP Neon Genesis Evangelion	1995	2015	+20 yrs
Space: Above and Beyond	1995	2063	+68 yrs
Star Trek: Voyager	1995	2371	+376 yrs
JP Bubblegum Crisis Tokyo 2040*	1998	2040	+42 yrs
JP Cowboy Bebop	1998	2071	+73 yrs
Batman Beyond*	1999	2039	+40 yrs
CA/DE Total Recall 2070*	1999	2070	+71 yrs
Crusade	1999	2267	+268 yrs
Futurama	1999	3000	+1,001 yrs

2000s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
Dark Angel	2000	2019	+19 yrs
Cleopatra 2525*	2000	2525	+525 yrs
Star Trek: Enterprise	2001	2151	+150 yrs
Jeremiah	2002	2021	+19 yrs
JP Ghost in the Shell: Stand Alone Complex	2002	2030	+28 yrs
Firefly	2002	2517	+515 yrs
JP Planetes	2003	2075	+72 yrs
JP Fafner in the Azure*	2004	2146	+142 yrs
JP Dennō Coil	2007	2026	+19 yrs
JP Mobile Suit Gundam 00	2007	2307	+300 yrs

2010s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
Terra Nova*	2011	2149	+138 yrs
JP Sword Art Online	2012	2022	+10 yrs
Revolution	2012	2027	+15 yrs
Fringe (season 5)	2012	2036	+24 yrs
CA Continuum*	2012	2077	+65 yrs
JP Psycho-Pass	2012	2112	+100 yrs
Defiance	2013	2046	+33 yrs
Almost Human	2013	2048	+35 yrs
The 100*	2014	2149	+135 yrs
12 Monkeys*	2015	2043	+28 yrs
Mars	2016	2033	+17 yrs
Westworld*	2016	2052	+36 yrs
Incorporated	2016	2074	+58 yrs
▶ Star Trek: Discovery	2017	2256	+239 yrs
The Orville	2017	2418	+401 yrs
▶ Lost in Space (2018)	2018	2046	+28 yrs
Nightflyers	2018	2093	+75 yrs
▶ Altered Carbon	2018	2384	+366 yrs
Years and Years*	2019	2034	+15 yrs

2020s

	First aired	Setting year	Span
Snowpiercer*	2020	2021	+1 yr
▶ Upload	2020	2033	+13 yrs
▶ ES La Valla	2020	2045	+25 yrs
▶ JP Ghost in the Shell: SAC_2045	2020	2045	+25 yrs
▶ Star Trek: Lower Decks	2020	2380	+360 yrs
▶ Star Trek: Picard	2020	2399	+379 yrs
▶ Cowboy Bebop (2021)	2021	2071	+50 yrs
Intergalactic	2021	2143	+122 yrs
▶ Star Trek: Prodigy	2021	2383	+362 yrs
▶ The Peripheral	2022	2032	+10 yrs
▶ PL/JP Cyberpunk: Edgerunners	2022	2075	+53 yrs
▶ Star Trek: Strange New Worlds	2022	2259	+237 yrs
▶ KR Black Knight	2023	2071	+48 yrs
▶ Fallout	2024	2296	+272 yrs
Alien: Earth	2025	2120	+95 yrs
▶ Star Trek: Starfleet Academy	2026	3195	+1,169 yrs

JP Made outside the UK/US (ISO country code; SU = Soviet Union) CA Co-production with the UK/US, led by the country shown (first-listed)

First aired Setting year (near future) Setting year (far future) Title colour: year ambiguous* ▶ Streaming-first release

* Ambiguous, derived, framing-story only, or not stated on screen; see series.csv notes. Multi-year settings use the starting year. Sources: Wikipedia (EN/JA/ES), SFE, Netflix Tudum, Collider, Business Insider and others. Draft v1, October 2026.